The R&AW in April 1979 cautioned the Indian government that the insurgency in Afghanistan had assumed serious proportions. Disturbances were taking place in most provinces of the country, with reports of desertions from the armed forces and an obvious erosion of morale. The Taraki regime was roping in civilian party cadres and teenage schoolchildren for crash courses in military training as they apprehended increasing aggression by Pakistan into Afghan territory.

Reddy said the Pakhtoons in Pakistani territory were unhappy with Taraki for two reasons—they were not getting vocal support from the government and the religious persecution of tribal leaders by the Afghan authorities was triggering a migration to Balochistan. This was an ideal situation for Pakistan, which had decided to use the Afghan migrants flocking to its soil against Taraki. Pakistan had not forgotten or forgiven Afghan leaders for supporting Pakhtoonistan and therefore another division of Pakistan. It had earlier warned Afghan leaders not to intervene in its domestic affairs and now it was Afghanistan's turn to complain about Pakistan's growing interference in its internal situation.

On 27 May 1979, President Taraki decided to hold a meeting with the Afghan ulemas to soothe religious nerves. Reddy said the discussion was primarily a message to Pakistan that it should not interfere in Afghanistan's internal affairs and must stop the infiltration of mujahideen who attacked villages, massacred the inhabitants and subsequently gave the incidents an Islamic colour.

In June 1979, after the visit of Abha Maiti, India's minister of state for industry, India intensified cooperation with Afghanistan. Specific fields in which India offered assistance